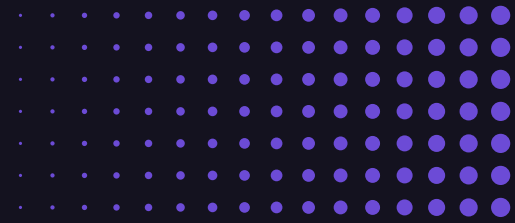


FALSE DAWN

A comic-book action game where the light was never on your side.

GAME JAM PROPOSAL | COMIC - TWIST - LIGHT | Team: Illuminati



1 THE PITCH

You follow a friendly Narrator who calls the warm gold energy he gives you **Light** and the soft violet energy of the creatures you hunt **Shade**. He has it backwards, and every enemy you defeat is feeding him.

False Dawn is a 3D comic-book action game for the browser. You fight through a living comic world drawn in ink and halftone, guided by a Narrator who speaks through caption boxes, teaches you new moves and cheers on every kill. Around minute ten, one reveal turns the game inside out, and the second half keeps the same combat loop with new energy, new abilities and a new look, so the twist is felt through play and not only seen in a cutscene.

At a glance

Genre	3D third-person action brawler played in compact arenas
Platform	Browser (WebGL), hosted on itch.io
Playtime	About 15 minutes at a relaxed pace, with short fights and breathing room between them
Controls	Keyboard and mouse (gamepad as a stretch goal)

2 HOW THE THEMES FIT

Theme	How it is built into the game
Comic	The 3D world is drawn like a comic: cel-shaded characters, thick ink outlines, halftone shading, and sound effects like THWACK that pop up in the scene on every hit. The Narrator is a caption box that lives in the world and grows as the story goes on.
Twist	The reveal is mechanical as well as narrative. The palette, lighting, enemy behaviour and the player's abilities all flip, and clues from the first half suddenly mean the opposite.
Light	Light is the central mechanic, the central lie and the real lighting of the scene. The world is lit gold by the Narrator's energy, and at the twist every light flips to violet: the true light that came from the creatures the player was told to fight.

3 STORY (CONTAINS THE TWIST)

SPOILER SECTION: the full twist, included so the judges can evaluate the design.

The lie. The hero wakes in a comic world where a cheerful Narrator warns of corrupted "Shades". Each Shade defeated releases a violet wisp. He says it is being banished, but it drifts into his caption box, which grows a little larger and louder with every kill. The Shades are not corrupted: they carry the true light, and the gold energy he gave you is the dark one.

The Warden. The last "villain" is the Warden, a guardian who mostly defends. When the hero defeats him, the last of the stolen light frees the Narrator.

The twist. The caption box shatters. The Narrator steps out of the page, takes back his gold energy and strips the hero of their powers. The colours invert: violet now glows like real light and gold looks like what it always was. The world collapses, and with his dying breath the Warden passes the true light to the hero.

The real fight. The hero faces the Narrator, who carries the stolen souls of every Shade as armour. Defeating him frees them, and in the last panel the hero takes the pen and writes the final caption.

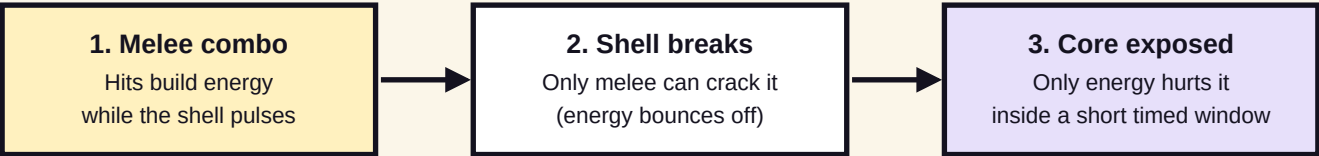
Clues planted in the first half: wisps always drift toward the caption box, the box grows with every kill, gold energy has a slight visual buzz while violet is calm, and Shades hesitate and block more than they attack.

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CORE GAMEPLAY

- **Melee is the engine.** A responsive combo and dodge are the foundation, and landing hits builds energy.
- **Energy is the payoff.** Spending it produces the strongest moves and is the only way to break armour cores.
- **The Narrator is the teacher and the trap.** He introduces each mechanic through friendly banter, which makes the betrayal land harder.

Two-layer armour



Melee alone cannot hurt the core. Energy alone cannot crack the shell, so both are needed.

Armoured enemies and bosses have a shell and a core, so the player must combine melee and energy. Telegraphed plates open for a short window and the player hits them with the right move at the right time.

Abilities (direction)	What the player gets
First half: gold energy	An energy shot or burst, plus the dodge, introduced one at a time by the Narrator.
Second half: true light	Violet versions that play differently: a piercing strike, absorbing enemy energy and turning it into charge, and a freed-soul assist.

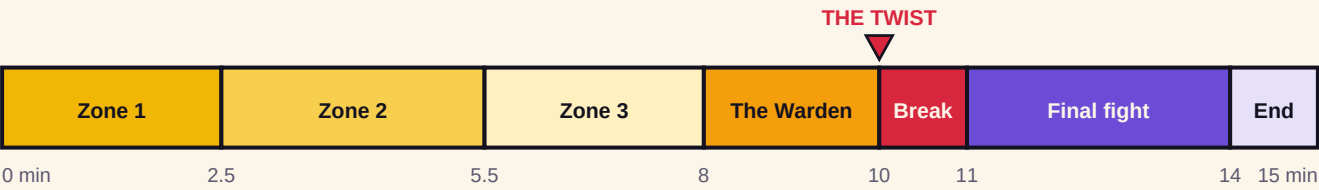
Exact abilities and numbers will be tuned during development.

Enemies and bosses. Two enemy types (light Grunts and armoured Brutes) re-skinned per zone, the Warden as a defensive guardian boss, and the Narrator as a two-phase final boss that inverts everything the player has learned.

Feel and pacing. Hit-stop, screen shake and comic sound-effect pops make combat punchy. The camera is a fixed-angle follow camera framed like a comic panel. Fights are short and spaced out by walking sections and Narrator banter, so a relaxed 15-minute run never feels rushed.

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RUN OF PLAY (ABOUT 15 MINUTES)



Minutes	Segment	What the player does
0-2.5	Zone 1	Moves, fights and dodges while the Narrator teaches through banter. Small groups of Grunts.
2.5-5.5	Zone 2	Meets armoured Brutes. The Narrator hands over gold energy, and the player learns to open and break plates.
5.5-8	Zone 3	Mixed fights that combine everything. The caption box is now visibly huge.
8-10	The Warden	Defensive boss with two armour cycles to break. He barely attacks.
10-11	The twist	The Narrator is freed, powers are stripped, the world collapses and the Warden passes on the true light.
11-14	Final fight	Two phases with true-light abilities, ending by freeing the stolen souls.
14-15	Ending	A short epilogue as the hero writes the last caption.